Her parents set up the Neerja Bhanot Pan Am Trust with insurance money and funds from Pan Am for using the brand Pan Am in the title. The trust presents two awards every year, one to honour a flight **crew** member, worldwide, who acts beyond the call of duty and another to an Indian woman who overcomes social **injustice** and helps other women in similar social distress. The award includes a sum of INR 1,50,000, a trophy and a citation.

One of the children who this brave flight purser saved during a hijacking incident in 1986 is now a captain of a major airline.

Some people shine even after death and she was among them. Even the streets of Mumbai couldn't forget her. A square in Mumbai's Ghatkopar (East) suburb was named after her by the Mumbai Municipal Corporation.

Discuss and Answer.

1. Why was Neerja awarded the Ashok Chakra?
2. How was Neerja honoured by various governments?
3. What are the selection criteria for the Neerja Bhanot Pan Am Award?

GLOSSARY

civilian	-	a person not in the armed services or police force
posthumously	-	after the death of the person
crew	-	a group of people who work on a ship, aircraft or train
injustice	-	lack of justice, unfairness

DO YOU KNOW?

The "black box" is made up of two separate pieces of equipment: the flight data recorder (FDR) and a cockpit voice recorder (CVR). They are compulsory on any commercial flight or corporate jet, and are usually kept in the tail of an aircraft, where they are more likely to survive a crash. FDRs record things like airspeed, altitude, vertical acceleration and fuel flow. Early versions used wire string to encode the data; these days they use solid-state memory boards. Solid-state recorders in large aircraft can track more than 700 parameters.



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